

A Memory dump file creation is a very useful diagnostic tool in Windows systems based on NT. A memory dump is an output file generated by the OS during a crash, and is useful in determining the cause of the crash. It is saved as a file with the .dmp extension in the 'System32' directory inside the 'Windows' directory.

To set up this option, open 'System' in 'Control Panel', navigate to the 'Advanced' tab, and click 'Settings' under 'Startup and Recovery'.

The dump file can be analysed using a tool from Microsoft known as dumpchk.exe. You can download it from <http://snipurl.com/gzel>. Different versions of the tool are available for different versions of Windows. Detailed information about using dumpchk.exe can be found at <http://snipurl.com/gzf8>.

BIOS Upgrade Needed

Q I have an Intel P III 450 MHz (Katmai) processor, Intel (i440BX/ZX-SMC60X rev. C1, Intel 82371 (PIIX4) rev. C1) Chipset, Inno3D GeForce4 MX 64 MB, 128 MB of RAM, a DVD/CD-RW, Windows 98 SE, and a 20 GB hard disk. I have the following questions:

1. Can I use a P III 1 GHz Processor with this chipset? Is there some other fast processor that I can use with this chipset?
2. How can I upgrade my BIOS? I have the Award 4.51 P-03/01/99 BIOS. I am unable to install Windows XP. Is this a BIOS problem? Does this BIOS support only Windows 95/98?
3. While burning CDs, disk finalisation fails, and the disk becomes unusable. Why is it so? I can play games like *Call of Duty*, *NFS Hot Pursuit 2* and *GTA Vice-City* on my PC, and they run very well.

Zaif Khan, Delhi



A Unfortunately, you will not be able to use a 1 GHz P III on your board—the board simply does not support that processor. You can upgrade your BIOS by downloading the latest BIOS and BIOS flashing utility from your motherboard manufacturer's Web site.

The Award 4.51 BIOS has certain limitations. When a hard drive larger than 33.8 GB is attached, the system hangs during Power-On Self Test. But you should be able to install Windows XP even with this BIOS.

CD burning can fail during finalisation for a variety of reasons—due to faulty media or a faulty writer. Try using different media. Use a cleaning CD to clean the lens of your CD-Writer—dust may have accumulated over it. Try burning at lower speeds.

Missing Music

Q My system configuration is a P IV, an Intel 845 motherboard, and 256 MB of DDR RAM running Windows XP. Whenever I try to open Windows Media Player, I get the following error: "winplayer.exe - ENTRY POINT NOT FOUND. The procedure entry point ASFSend Time To Time could not be located in the dynamic link library WMASF.DLL"

It's only recently that I've started experiencing

this problem. I've tried to restore the system to an earlier date, but the problem persists. What is the solution?

Prof Sanjay S Patil, Ratnagiri

A You need to reinstall Windows Media Player. Go to **Control Panel > Folder Options > View** and set it to 'Show hidden files and folders'. Uncheck 'Hide protected operating system files [recommended]' and 'Hide extensions for known file types'. Now, open the Windows Explorer and go to the 'C:\Windows\Inf' folder, find the file 'wmp.inf', right-click it and choose 'Install'.

You will need to either insert your Windows XP CD or know where the i386 folder is located on your hard drive. You may also need to know where the 'ServicePackFiles' folder is (it's usually under the Windows directory) if you've installed a service pack. If your Windows directory is 'C:\Windows', then the service pack files are in 'C:\Windows\ServicePackFiles'.

Icons For CDs

Q How do I assign an icon to the CD-R/W while writing it, so that when I put it into the drive the icon appears at the place of the CD drive in 'My Computer'?

Ajay Bhushan, via e-mail

A The icon displayed in 'My Computer' when some CDs are inserted into the CD drive is due to the Autorun feature of the CD. The root of an Autorun CD contains a file 'autorun.inf', which is an instruction file associated with the function. This file has a syntax, and a simple autorun.inf file looks like

```
[autorun]
open=autorun.exe
icon=autorun.ico
```

Here, 'autorun.exe' is the executable file that is launched when the CD is inserted, and 'autorun.ico' is the icon file that gives the CD its icon. Sometimes, an executable file or a DLL that might contain an icon is also used instead of an icon file. You may also try a freeware Autorun file editor such as the one from <http://autorun.moonvalley.com> if you want to play around with Autorun files.

I Lost My Password!

Q I use MS Office 2000 on my computer. I created an MS Word file and saved it with password protection. I've forgotten the password. How can I open the file?

Vikram Dan, Barmer, Rajasthan

A To recover the password of an MS Word file, download software such as the Word Password Recovery from Interlore (<http://snipurl.com/gzfo>) or the Password Word Key (<http://snipurl.com/gzey>).

A fast processor enables quick recovery of the password. Short passwords are easy to recover, but longer passwords may take days